THE OTHER PERSON IN THE ROOM

Podcast Series Bible • Every episode 12–15 minutes. Hard stop at 15:00.

Host: Jamison Parker • 14 episodes (Prologue + 12 interviews + Finale) • Tagline: Everybody has something sitting in the room with them.

15-MINUTE CLOCK

0:00–0:40 title + content note • 0:40–2:00 host open / the room • 2:00–11:00 conversation • 11:00–13:30 the illness speaks • 13:30–15:00 afterward + close. If the raw tape runs long, keep one origin beat, one cost beat, one “what I wish you knew” beat, then the illness. Leave silences. Cut repetition.

EPISODES — ALL 12–15 MINUTES

Ep 0 — Prologue — *The Other Person in the Room*

Premise in under two minutes. Ends on Sarah and the clipboard.

> *“Mine would be sitting behind me. Slightly to the left. Holding a clipboard.”*

Ep 1 — Sarah + Anxiety — *The Clipboard*

Content note: Anxiety, hypervigilance, risk assessment.

Passive-aggressive project manager. Calls her staff. Keeps useful receipts, deletes the rest.

> *“You don’t get a medal for not burning the house down.”*

Ep 2 — Marcus + Depression — *The Landlord*

Content note: Depression, numbness, isolation.

Weary landlord. Polite about the demolition. Offers an explanation so emptiness isn’t personal.

> *“I’m almost merciful. In a completely unhelpful way. That’s my brand.”*

Ep 3 — Elena + Trauma — *The Security Guard Who Never Clocks Off*

Content note: Complex trauma, PTSD, hypervigilance. No graphic events.

Never sits down. Laminates the one real incident. Deletes the ninety-nine false alarms.

> *“People who say I’m still here are usually about to stop checking.”*

Ep 4 — David + Bipolar — *The Weather*

Content note: Bipolar mood states, mania, crashes.

Two people, one chair, fighting the thermostat. He misses the high. Not the crash.

> *“You don’t apologise for electricity.”*

Ep 5 — Priya + OCD — *The Endless Play*

Content note: OCD sequences, cost of rituals.

Exhausted director. Script grows while you watch. Relief lasts forty seconds.

> *“Forty seconds of safety is still safety. You’re welcome.”*

Ep 6 — Tom + Addiction — *The Ex Who Still Has a Key*

Content note: Alcohol addiction and recovery. No using detail.

Remembers good nights, none of the damage. Still tries the door. Celebrate the Tuesdays.

> *“I can wait. I am extremely patient. And I have excellent timing.”*

Ep 7 — Aisha + Panic — *National Emergency*

Content note: Panic attacks, false alarms that feel life-threatening.

Heart rate treated like a burning building. Does not do maybe later.

> *“I will finish when I finish. Your schedule is not my problem.”*

Ep 8 — Liam + Rejection Sensitivity — *Advanced Pattern Recognition*

Content note: ADHD rejection sensitivity, perceived abandonment.

“I need space” arrives as “I am leaving forever.” Means well, destroys things.

“Advanced pattern recognition with a strong bias toward survival.”

Ep 9 — Sophie + Dysmorphia — *The Hostile Witness*

Content note: Body dysmorphia, disordered eating history. No behaviours or numbers.

The mirror is a hostile witness. Silence about the body is care.

“The measurements do not lie. Kindness does.”

Ep 10 — Jordan + Grief — *The Space That Won’t Vacate*

Content note: Complicated grief after a sibling’s death.

Sits in the brother’s space. No deadline. Sit with me.

“I do not leave. That is the entire job description.”

Ep 11 — Mei + Social Anxiety — *The Thermostat*

Content note: Social anxiety, fear of judgement.

Every sentence is a potential exit. Silence is how she stays.

“Better to say nothing than to say the thing that makes them leave.”

Ep 12 — Alex + The Low Voice — *The Question That Stays Open*

Content note: Persistent depression, passive ideation. No plans or methods. Focus on staying.

Quiet radio that never quite goes off. You don’t have to feel better to stay.

“The answer is his. The question remains mine.”

Ep 13 — Finale — *The Other Person Was Me*

Jamison turns the lens. One line from each of the twelve. Then the close.

They don’t necessarily get to decide who lives there.

RELEASE

Weekly. Launch with Episode 0. Then Sarah through Alex. Finale the week after Episode 12. Fourteen episodes total — under a cap of fifteen.

SERIES CLOSE

The illnesses may occupy rooms. They may rearrange the furniture. They may turn the lights off. They may sometimes convince the person there is no door. But they are not the whole house. A diagnosis can describe a person’s experience without becoming their identity. The other person may always be in the room. But they don’t necessarily get to decide who lives there.

Support: Australia Lifeline 13 11 14 • Beyond Blue 1300 22 4636